

Start with the three whys

Use the three whys to anchor the conversation before showing architecture or BVA outputs

Why Change?

Aging Db2 environments create support risk, operational friction, delayed AI readiness, and avoidable upgrade pressure.

Why Now?

Renewals, platform moves, skills pressure, resilience expectations, and AI initiatives are already forcing decisions.

Why IBM?

IBM can connect the modernization path, Db2 capabilities, technical proof, and Value 360 BVA into one defensible story.

Client-facing line

“Based on similar environments and approved benchmarks, these are the areas where clients typically see value. To calculate the value for your environment, we would validate the inputs with you.”

What changed from rehearsal: Start with the why narrative. Then use the architecture view. Then show the Value 360 output as a starting point, not a finished client answer.

Pick one modernization motion

Keep the first meeting focused. Do not walk the client through every possible path.

Vitality

Becoming current, supported, secure, and ready for newer Db2 capabilities.

Containerization

Moving to a standardized Kubernetes operating model with repeatable deployment patterns.

SaaS / Managed

Shifting operational responsibility for infrastructure, upgrades, HA, DR, and backup.

Tradeup / Expansion

Extending Db2 with AI Edition, vector support, autonomous operations, and broader data use cases.

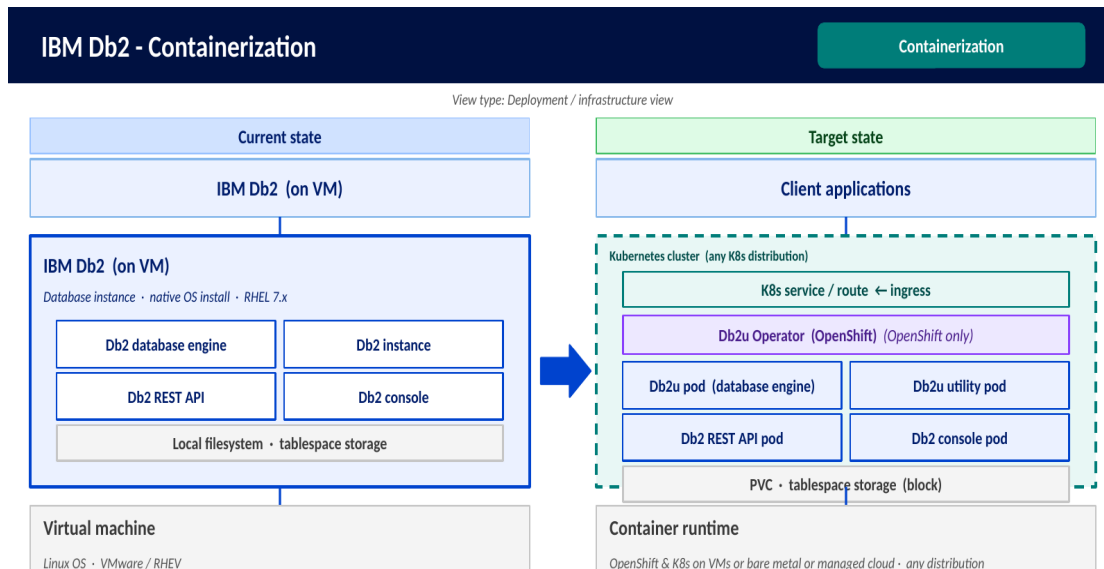
Seller rule: Work with the account team and CSE to select the motion before the meeting. The goal is a focused discussion, not a tour of every possible plan.

Client ask: “Can we validate if this is the right path, then use your inputs to build the business case?”

Avoid making modernization feel like a large rip-and-replace program.

Technical view = product proof

Use the technical view to explain what changes. Do not use it as the value calculation.



Example shown: Containerization

Use one technical view to show current state, target state, and enabled Db2 capabilities.

Seller talk track

“This view shows the technical change and the Db2 capabilities enabled by the move.”

Use it to confirm:

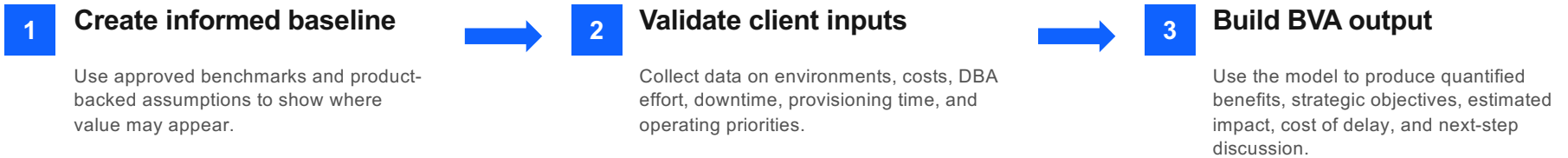
- current-state pattern
- target-state direction
- capability gaps
- operating model change

Then move to Value 360 for the value estimate.

The generic benefit text on the technical slide is not the BVA. It is only a prompt for the Value 360 model.

Value 360 = the client-specific value layer

Start with informed benchmarks. Refine with client data. Build the BVA output.



What sellers should say

“These are starting assumptions. The client-specific value depends on your environment and operating data.”

What sellers should not do

Do not present benchmark assumptions or generic benefit labels as confirmed client value.

Value 360 provides the business case engine. The technical view provides product proof. Client data makes the BVA real.